The ATM acts as a trusted intermediary between you and the bank by verifying each step of the transaction. It checks things like whether you entered the correct PIN, or whether your bank account has enough money. Imagine if instead of an ATM there was a stack of money and the bank trusted everyone to take the right amount. That bank wouldn't be in business long!

Like this ATM transaction, a CORS request has its own group of players with similar functionality. The players in a CORS request are the client, the browser, and the server.

3.3.1 The players in a CORS request

The key players in a CORS request are the client, the browser, and the server. The client wants some piece of data from the server, such as a JSON API response or the contents of a web page. The browser acts as the trusted intermediary to verify that the client can access the data from the server. Table 3.1 shows how these players fit with the ATM analogy.

Table 3.1 A CORS request consists of the client, the browser, and the server

CORS player	ATM analogy	Description
Client	You	Wants data from the server
Browser	ATM	Manages the communication between the client and the server
Server	Bank account	Serves the data the client wants

CLIENT

In the same way that you want money from your bank account, the client wants data from the server. The client is a snippet of JavaScript code running on a website, and it's responsible for initiating the CORS request. It's served from a particular domain and usually consists of an `XMLHttpRequest` to a remote server. The following code snippet highlights the portion from the sample's client.html file that is responsible for making the CORS request:

```
var xhr = createXhr('GET', 'http://127.0.0.1:9999/api/posts');
xhr.onload = function() {
  …
};
xhr.send();
```

Client versus user

Sometimes the words client and user are used interchangeably, but they are different in the context of CORS. A *user* is a person visiting a website, while a *client* is the actual code served by that website. Multiple users can visit the same website and be served the same JavaScript client code, as shown in figure 3.11. For the purposes of understanding CORS, we'll focus on the client and not on the user.